INGLÉS · NIVEL B1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Past Continuous en Inglés B1

Domina el past continuous para describir acciones en progreso en el pasado y narrar historias con contexto y dinamismo.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Usar el past continuous para describir acciones en progreso en el pasado y combinarlas con el past simple.

MODELO

I was reading when she called. / While he was cooking, I was setting the table.

Al terminar podrás

1. Forma el past continuous con was/were + verbo -ing correctamente
2. Usa past continuous para acciones en progreso en un momento pasado
3. Combina past continuous + past simple con when/while para interrupciones
4. Describe dos acciones simultáneas en el pasado con while

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve la práctica y corrige al final. Usa las tres pistas de audio de la lección web para imitar ritmo y entonación.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

El past continuous (was/were + -ing) describe acciones que estaban en progreso en un momento específico del pasado. En B1 aprendes a combinar el past continuous con el past simple para narrar interrupciones, acciones simultáneas y establecer el escenario de una historia.

¿Qué es el past continuous y cuándo se usa?

El past continuous (también llamado past progressive) describe una acción que estaba en progreso en un momento específico del pasado. Se forma con was (para I/he/she/it) o were (para you/we/they) más el verbo con -ing.

A diferencia del past simple que describe eventos completados, el past continuous "pausa el video" en el pasado y muestra lo que estaba ocurriendo en ese instante: "At midnight, the baby was crying." / "This time last year I was living in London."

Past continuous + when/while: interrupciones y simultaneidad

La combinación más importante en B1 es past continuous + when + past simple para expresar una interrupción. La acción larga (past continuous) estaba en progreso cuando la acción corta (past simple) la interrumpió: "I was having dinner when my boss called me."

Con while puedes presentar la misma idea o mostrar dos acciones simultáneas: "While she was cooking, he was watching TV." Aquí ambas acciones ocurrían al mismo tiempo y ambas van en past continuous.

Conector	Estructura	Significado
when	P.Cont + when + P.Simple	La 2ª acción interrumpe la 1ª
while (interrupción)	While + P.Cont, P.Simple	Igual a la línea anterior
while (simultáneo)	While + P.Cont, P.Cont	Dos acciones a la vez

Was vs Were: el error más común

La elección entre was y were sigue las mismas reglas que el verbo to be en pasado. Was se usa con I, he, she e it. Were se usa con you, we y they. No hay excepciones.

El error más frecuente es usar were con she/he/it: "She were cooking" es incorrecto. Siempre: "She was cooking." / "He was driving." / "It was raining."

Verbos que NO van en continuous (stative verbs)

Los verbos estativos describen estados, no acciones dinámicas. Los más importantes: know, want, need, like, love, hate, understand, believe, remember, belong, seem, appear, mean. Estos verbos no se usan en forma continuous.

Incorrecto: "I was knowing the answer." Correcto: "I knew the answer." En contextos del pasado, estos verbos siempre van en past simple.

El past continuous para establecer escenario en narrativas

En textos narrativos, el past continuous aparece al inicio para "pintar el escenario": "It was a cold evening. The rain was falling and the wind was howling. I was sitting by the fire..." Luego la historia avanza con past simple.

Este uso es fundamental para el Writing en IELTS, Cambridge y exámenes de inglés: la introducción en past continuous crea atmósfera, y los eventos principales van en past simple.

¿Cómo se forma el past continuous en inglés?

Con was/were + verbo -ing: "I was working", "they were playing". Se usa "was" con I/he/she/it y "were" con you/we/they. Negativo: wasn't/weren't + -ing; pregunta: "Were you working?".

¿Cuándo se usa el past continuous?

Para una acción en curso en un momento del pasado ("At 8 p.m. I was studying") y para la acción de fondo interrumpida por otra ("I was cooking when the phone rang"). Describe el proceso, no el evento puntual.

¿Cuál es la diferencia entre past simple y past continuous?

El past continuous describe la acción larga o de fondo ("I was watching TV"); el past simple, el evento puntual que la interrumpe ("...when she called"). Se combinan con "when" y "while": "While I was cooking, the phone rang".

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

Subject + was/were + verb-ing (+ when + past simple)

Decide en este orden

1. Usa was con I / he / she / it — usa were con you / we / they
2. Past continuous solo: acción en progreso en un momento específico "At 9 pm I was watching TV."
3. Past continuous + when + past simple: la acción larga es interrupted por la corta "I was sleeping when the alarm rang."
4. While + past continuous + past simple: misma idea, "while" introduce la acción larga "While I was sleeping, the alarm rang."
5. Dos past continuous con while: dos acciones simultáneas "While she was studying, he was playing."
6. Nunca uses past continuous con stative verbs: know, want, like, need, understand usa past simple.

Estructura	Ejemplo	Uso
was/were + -ing	She was reading a book.	Acción en progreso en el pasado
P.Cont + when + P.Simple	I was cooking when he arrived.	Acción interrumpida
While + P.Cont + P.Simple	While I was cooking, he arrived.	Misma idea, orden diferente

Errores frecuentes

× "I was know the answer" "I knew the answer" — verbos estativos usan past simple, no continuous.

× "She were working" "She was working" — she/he/it usan was, no were.

× "While I studied, she was cooking" "While I was studying, she was cooking" — ambas acciones simultáneas usan continuous.

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

I was working when the power went out.	Estaba trabajando cuando se fue la luz.
She was reading while he was cooking dinner.	Ella estaba leyendo mientras él cocinaba.
What were you doing at 8 pm last night?	¿Qué estabas haciendo a las 8 pm anoche?
They were watching a movie when it started to rain.	Estaban viendo una película cuando empezó a llover.
While I was driving, I heard the news.	Mientras conducía, escuché la noticia.
The kids were sleeping when we arrived.	Los niños estaban durmiendo cuando llegamos.
It was snowing and the streets were getting icy.	Estaba nevando y las calles se estaban poniendo heladas.
She wasn't feeling well, so she went home early.	No se sentía bien, así que se fue a casa temprano.

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

21 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

Reconoce la forma correcta

1. I ___ a shower when my phone rang. Opciones: was having · were having · had · am having

2. What ___ you ___ when the meeting started? Opciones: were / doing · was / doing · did / do · are / doing

3. We ___ in the park when it started to rain. Opciones: were walking · was walking · walked · are walking

4. She ___ to music while her brother was driving. Opciones: was listening · were listening · listened · is listening

5. The children ___ when we finally got home. Opciones: were sleeping · was sleeping · slept · are sleeping

6. Did you see the accident? No, I ___ in the other direction. Opciones: was looking · were looking · looked · look

7. While the manager ___ the report, the clients arrived. Opciones: was presenting · were presenting · presented · presents

8. It ___ heavily when the referee stopped the match. Opciones: was raining · were raining · rained · rains

Was/were + acción simultánea

9. While Maria _____ the house, her husband _____ in the garden. Opciones: was cleaning · were cleaning · cleaned · is cleaning / was working · were working · worked · is working

10. The speaker _____ when the lights suddenly _____ off. Opciones: was talking · were talking · talked · has talked / went · were going · was going · go

11. We _____ our meal when the fire alarm _____. Opciones: were enjoying · was enjoying · enjoyed · enjoy / went off · was going off · were going off · goes off

12. I _____ on my essay while my roommates _____ loudly in the living room. Opciones: was working · were working · worked · am working / were laughing · was laughing · laughed · laugh

La noche del apagón

13. It was a stormy evening last October. I _____ (study) at my desk when the electricity suddenly _____ (go) out. The whole neighborhood _____ (lose) power. Outside, the wind _____ (blow) and the rain _____ (fall) hard. I _____ (look) for some candles when I heard a knock at the door. My neighbor _____ (stand) there with a flashlight, looking scared.

Escribe sin opciones

14. Yesterday afternoon was quite eventful. At 4 pm I _____ (work) from home when my friend _____ (call) me. While we _____ (talk), I heard a loud noise outside. I _____ (look) out the window and saw a car accident. The drivers _____ (argue) in the street.

Producción guiada

15. Describe qué estabas haciendo cuando sonó tu teléfono ayer (usa past continuous + when + past simple).

_____

16. Describe dos cosas que tú y otra persona hacían al mismo tiempo (usa while + past continuous).

_____

17. Describe qué estabas haciendo a las 10 pm anoche (usa past continuous + time expression).

_____

18. Escribe 2 oraciones de past continuous para establecer el escenario de una historia (clima, personas, etc.).

_____

Misión: Cuéntame tu día

19. Escribe lo que estabas haciendo ayer a una hora específica (e.g., at 7 pm).

_____

20. Cuéntame algo que te interrumpió mientras hacías algo ayer (past continuous + when + past simple).

_____

21. Describe dos cosas simultáneas que tú y alguien más hacían ayer (while + past continuous).

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. was having — I was (not were). La acción estaba en progreso cuando el teléfono interrumpió.
2. were / doing — You were. Pregunta por la acción en progreso antes de la reunión.
3. were walking — We were + walking. Acción en progreso interrumpida por la lluvia.
4. was listening — She was. Acción simultánea con otra acción (her brother was driving).
5. were sleeping — The children were. Acción en progreso en ese momento del pasado.
6. was looking — I was. Acción en progreso en el momento del accidente.
7. was presenting — The manager was (tercera persona singular). Past continuous interrumpido por la llegada de los clientes.
8. was raining — It was (sujeto impersonal). La lluvia estaba en progreso cuando el árbitro paró el partido.
9. was cleaning / was working — Maria was cleaning. Acción simultánea en past continuous. Her husband was working. Ambas acciones simultáneas usan past continuous.
10. was talking / went — The speaker was talking. Acción en progreso interrumpida. "Go off" (apagarse) es la acción interrupciones past simple: went.
11. were enjoying / went off — We were enjoying. Acción larga interrumpida. La alarma sonar es la interrupción past simple: went off.
12. was working / were laughing — I was working. Acción simultánea. My roommates were laughing. Dos acciones simultáneas, ambas en past continuous.
13. was studying / went / lost / was blowing / was falling / was looking / was standing — I was studying. Acción en progreso interrumpida por el apagón. El apagón es un evento repentino e interrumpe past simple: went out. Evento puntual/resultado past simple: lost. El viento como escenario en progreso past continuous: was blowing. La lluvia como escenario en progreso past continuous: was falling. Acción en progreso cuando escuché el golpe past continuous: was looking. Posición/estado en progreso en ese momento past continuous: was standing.
14. was working / called / were talking / looked / were arguing — I was working. Acción en progreso a las 4 pm. La llamada es la interrupción past simple: called. We were talking. Acción en progreso cuando escuché el ruido. Acción puntual de respuesta past simple: looked. The drivers were arguing. Acción en progreso que yo observé.
15. I was having lunch when my phone rang. — Ejemplo: I was studying when my phone rang. / I was cooking when my friend called.
16. While I was studying, my sister was watching TV. — Ejemplo: While I was cooking, my roommate was cleaning. Usa while + past continuous para ambas acciones.
17. At 10 pm last night I was watching a series on Netflix. — Ejemplo: At 10 pm I was getting ready for bed. / Last night at that time I was talking to my family.
18. It was raining and the streets were getting dark. People were rushing home. — Ejemplo: The sun was shining and children were playing in the park. A dog was barking in the distance.
19. At 7 pm I was having dinner with my family. — Usa: At [hora] I was [verbo -ing]. Ej: At 3 pm I was working on a project.
20. I was reading when my neighbor knocked at the door. — Usa: I was [acción] when [interrupción]. Ej: I was studying when the power went out.
21. While I was working, my partner was cooking a delicious meal. — Usa: While I was [acción], [persona] was [acción]. Ej: While I was studying, my roommate was playing music.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.